

Sunday, 13 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light rain

22° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Rain

23° 17°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

21° 16°

GLASGOW

Overcast

18° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1

Reform UK has received another massive donation, with a crypto investor matching a record-breaking £36 million gift to the party.

Christopher Harborne's donation equals the single largest gift ever made to a UK political party, coming just two days after a similar sum from Ben Delo. It certainly puts Reform in the headlines.

POLITICS · UK

2

A bus driver in Northern Ireland was threatened with a knife and kept on board during a police chase after his vehicle was hijacked.

Passengers were safely allowed to leave the bus before the pursuit began. Police are investigating the incident, which saw the bus chased through the streets.

CRIME · UK

3

Rival protests have taken place in Portsmouth as new police powers regarding face masks come into force.

Demonstrators marched through the city, highlighting tensions surrounding the controversial new regulations. It's a story that could spark debate across the country.

LAW · UK

4

Saudi Arabia has shut down a crucial oil pipeline following a drone attack that originated from Iraq.

Iraq has removed a military commander and launched an investigation into the incident, which occurred in an area bordering Iran. This has significant implications for global oil supply.

WORLD AFFAIRS · INTERNATIONAL

5

French officials are investigating whether a malicious act caused a passenger train derailment that left 44 people injured.

A rail fragment was found on the tracks after Friday's crash, prompting concerns about foul play. It's a serious incident that could have been much worse.

ACCIDENT · EUROPE

What's coming up

1 **The Prodigy have been announced as the first headline act for Creamfields 2027, promising an electrifying return to the festival.**

Fans are already buzzing about the dance music legends topping the bill. It's set to be a huge event for electronic music lovers.

ON AIR – Are you excited to see The Prodigy back on the festival circuit, or is there another act you'd love to see headline?

MUSIC · COMING UP

2 **Céline Dion has been delighting fans by duetting with them ahead of her highly anticipated comeback concert in Paris.**

The Canadian singer, who was diagnosed with an incurable condition four years ago, is making a much-anticipated return to the stage. It's wonderful to see her back.

ON AIR – What's your favourite Céline Dion song, and how much are you looking forward to her return?

MUSIC · COMING UP

3 **Stacey Solomon and Alesha Dixon are set to host The Voice UK in an exciting ITV revamp of the popular singing competition.**

They'll be replacing Emma Willis, who is stepping down after hosting the show since 2014. It's a fresh new look for the series.

ON AIR – What do you think of Stacey and Alesha taking over The Voice? Will you be tuning in?

TV · COMING UP

4 **The Bayeux Tapestry exhibition at the British Museum is creating a huge buzz, with crowds flocking to see it.**

It's the first time this incredible nearly 1,000-year-old tapestry has been displayed in the UK since it was created. Many visitors are calling it a 'real privilege' to witness.

ON AIR – Have you seen the Bayeux Tapestry, or is it on your must-see list? What historical artefacts would you love to see in person?

EXHIBITION · NOW

5 **Rockstar Games has finally broken its silence on the Grand Theft Auto 6 leaks, expressing 'heartbreak' over the unauthorised footage.**

Clips of the highly anticipated game appeared online, causing a stir among fans and developers alike. It's a massive title for the gaming world.

ON AIR – Do you think these leaks will ultimately hurt the game's release, or just build more hype for GTA 6?

GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1 **Lando Norris has secured a superb pole position for McLaren at the Spanish Grand Prix, beating out top rivals.**

His 'gorgeous' lap put him ahead of Mercedes' Kimi Antonelli and Red Bull's Max Verstappen. It sets up an exciting race tomorrow.

ON AIR – Can Lando Norris convert pole position into a win in Spain? What are your predictions for the Grand Prix?
F1 · UK

2 **Saffie Osborne has made history, becoming the first female jockey to win a British Classic Flat race.**

She claimed victory in the St Leger on Highwayman, marking a landmark moment for the sport. It's a fantastic achievement.

ON AIR – How significant is Saffie Osborne's win for women in sport? What other barriers would you like to see broken?
HORSE RACING · UK

3 **England's Test cricket team completed a 3-0 clean sweep against Pakistan, recovering from an early scare in the final match.**

Captain Joe Root and Jordan Cox rescued England, chasing down 130 to win by eight wickets. It's been a dominant series for the home side.

ON AIR – After a tumultuous summer, how do you rate England's performance against Pakistan? What does this mean for the team going forward?
CRICKET · UK

4 **England's women produced a dominant second-half performance to comfortably defeat Australia in the opening game of the new WXV Global Series.**

It's a strong start to the series for the Red Roses, showcasing their power and teamwork. A great result for English rugby.

ON AIR – How important is this win for England's women's rugby team? Are you following the WXV Global Series?
RUGBY · UK

5 **American Ben Shelton powered past Frances Tiafoe in an all-American semi-final to reach the US Open final.**

He will now face number one seed Alexander Zverev in Sunday's final, promising a thrilling conclusion to the tournament. Who are you backing?

ON AIR – Who do you think will lift the US Open trophy – Shelton or Zverev? Have you enjoyed the tennis this year?
TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-adventures' close to home for a dose of fun and exploration.**
Instead of big trips, folks are discovering the joy of exploring local parks, woodlands, or even their own garden with a fresh sense of adventure. It's all about making the most of what's around you.
- 2 The simple pleasure of 'writing postcards' is making a heartwarming comeback amongst all ages.**
Sending a handwritten note through the post is a lovely way to connect with friends and family, and people are finding it a more personal touch than a quick text message. It's a little slice of nostalgia.
- 3 Many are finding peace and quiet by 'visiting their local library' for more than just books.**
Libraries are becoming community hubs, offering quiet spaces for work or reading, free internet access, and even local interest groups. It's a wonderful, calm escape from the everyday hustle.
- 4 The delightful art of 'collecting interesting pebbles' from walks is gaining surprising popularity.**
Whether it's for their unique patterns, colours, or just a fond memory of a day out, people are finding joy in these small, natural treasures. It's a lovely, simple hobby.
- 5 A new report highlights the growing popularity of 'community garden projects' across the country.**
These green spaces are bringing people together to grow food, share skills, and enjoy the outdoors. It's a fantastic way to build connections and beautify local areas.
- 6 People are finding comfort in the quiet ritual of 'listening to radio plays and audio dramas'.**
With so many fantastic productions available, tuning in allows your imagination to run wild. It's a lovely way to unwind and enjoy a story without any screen time.
- 7 The charming habit of 'leaving cheerful chalk messages' on pavements is spreading smiles in neighbourhoods.**
From simple 'hello's to uplifting quotes, these temporary artworks are a lovely, unexpected way to brighten someone's day. It's a sweet, fleeting gesture of kindness.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of tea will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE DRY TEA LEAVES IN THE PACKET BEFORE BUYING IT.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, warm bath, especially if it's a new bath bomb. What is it?

ANSWER: ALWAYS WATCHING THE BATH BOMB DISSOLVE COMPLETELY BEFORE GETTING IN.

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' just seems to have an unusual or funny face in it, like a plug socket or a coffee stain?

Do you ever spot 'faces' in inanimate objects around your house or when you're out and about? What's the funniest or most surprising one you've ever seen?

- We all have that 'one comfort food' that, no matter how old we get, can still instantly transport us back to our childhood or a happy memory, don't we?

What's that one specific dish or treat that, just by looking at it, or even just thinking about it, instantly brings back those warm, nostalgic feelings for you? Tell us all about it!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, and one circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins have a special gland that allows them to drink salty seawater, turning it fresh inside their bodies.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£14 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 officially started in a bakery on Pudding Lane.
- The collective noun for a group of owls is a 'parliament'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The small plastic tip on the end of a shoelace is called an 'aglet'.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The Queen of England owned all the unmarked swans in the open waters of the United Kingdom.

On this day

Day 256 of the year, 109 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Feast of the Cross (Assyrian Church of the East); Christian feast day: Aimé (Amatus); Christian feast day: Amé (Amatus) of Remiremont; Christian feast day: John Chrysostom. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1954 — Isiah Whitlock Jr., American actor (died 2025)
- 1957 — Mal Donaghy, Northern Irish footballer and manager
- 1963 — Robin Smith, South African-English cricketer
- 1977 — Fiona Apple, American singer-songwriter, producer, and pianist
- 1952 — Randy Jones, American pop and disco singer
- 1939 — Richard Kiel, American actor and voice artist (died 2014)
- 1946 — Frank Marshall, American director and producer
- 1940 — Brian Brain, English cricketer (died 2023)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1989 — Largest anti-Apartheid march in South Africa, led by Desmond Tutu.
- 1953 — Nikita Khrushchev is appointed General Secretary of the Communist Party of the Soviet Union.
- 1997 — A German Air Force Tupolev Tu-154 and a United States Air Force Lockheed C-141 Starlifter collide in mid-air near Namibia, killing 33.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1968 — Cold War: Albania leaves the Warsaw Pact.
- 1971 — Chairman Mao Zedong's second in command and successor Marshal Lin Biao flees China after the failure of an alleged coup. His plane crashes in Mongolia, killing all aboard.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1993 — Israeli Prime Minister Yitzhak Rabin shakes hands with Palestine Liberation Organization chairman Yasser Arafat at the White House after signing the Oslo Accords granting limited Palestinian autonomy.
- 1948 — Deputy Prime Minister of India Vallabhbhai Patel orders the Army to move into Hyderabad to integrate it with the Indian Union.

- 1971 — State police and National Guardsmen storm New York's Attica Prison to quell a prison revolt, which claimed 43 lives.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 257 of the year, 108 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aelia Flaccilla (Eastern Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Albert of Vercelli; Christian feast day: Cormac mac Cuilennáin (or of Cashel); Christian feast day: Crescentius of Rome. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1985 — Alex Clare, English singer and songwriter
- 1991 — Shayne Topp, American actor and Smosh cast member
- 1967 — John Power, English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1996 — Hugh Bernard, English cricketer
- 1978 — Danielle Peck, American singer-songwriter
- 1987 — Tinchy Stryder, Ghanaian-English rapper and producer
- 1934 — Don Walser, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2006)
- 1986 — Steven Naismith, Scottish footballer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1993 — Lufthansa Flight 2904, an Airbus A320, crashes into an embankment after overshooting the runway at Okęcie International Airport (now Warsaw Chopin Airport), killing two people.
- 2008 — Aeroflot Flight 821, a Boeing 737-500, crashes into a section of the Trans-Siberian Railway while on approach to Perm International Airport, in Perm, Russia, killing all 88 people on board.
- 1998 — Telecommunications companies MCI Communications and WorldCom complete their \$37 billion merger to form MCI WorldCom.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2002 — Total Linhas Aéreas Flight 5561 crashes near Paranapanema, Brazil, killing both pilots on board.
- 2007 — Prelude to the 2008 financial crisis: Northern Rock bank experiences the first bank run in the United Kingdom in 150 years.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar